A-A-2359
July 22, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CRAYON, MARKING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification SS-C-661.

This commercial item description (CID) covers genuine and processed soapstone crayons.

Composition I - Genuine soapstone crayon
Composition II - Processed soapstone crayon

The crayons are intended primarily for marking metals, fabrics, woods, and ceramics.

Salient characteristics.

Composition I. Composition I marking crayon shall be cut from genuine untreated soapstone (steatite). The crayon shall be of uniform strength and free from foreign matter.

Composition II. Composition II marking crayon shall be made of white talc and suitable binding materials.

Performance. The crayon shall be capable of making easily distinguishable white marks on bare, painted, dry, moist, or oily metal, fabric, wood or ceramic. The crayon shall not break when tested as specified.

Shape. The crayon shall be rectangular in cross section; both ends may be cut at 90 degrees with respect to the two adjacent sides, or one end may be so cut and the other end sharpened to a chisel edge, with the taper not to exceed 1/2 inch in length.

Dimensions. The minimum dimensions of the various shaped crayons shall be: rectangular - 5 inches x 1/2 inch x 3/16 inch; square - 5 inch x 1/4 inch x 1/4 inch; round - 5 inches x 1/4 inch diameter.

Workmanship. The crayon shall be free from defects which may impair serviceability.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with the Section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless othrwise specified, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or

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any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or purchase order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the CID where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that the supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Inspection of the end item. Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. The inspection level shall be II, with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 6.5 percent defective. The lot size shall consist of all packages containing one composition of crayon offered for acceptance at one time. The sample unit shall be one crayon.

Examination. Samples shall be examined for compliance with the specified requirements for material, shape, dimensions, and workmanship.

Tests. Two crayons shall be taken from each sample box selected for examination. One shall be subjected to the writing tests, the other to the strength tests. Failure of any crayon to pass either test shall result in rejection of the lot.

Writing test. Select one crayon at random from each sample box. Unless otherwise specifed, write one word having a minimum of five letters and draw five each of sharp turns,reversals, and circles on fabric, on dry and bare wood, and on ceramic.

Strength test. Select one crayon at random from each sample box. Place crayon perpendicular across two horizontal parallel rods 1/4 inch in diameter and 2-1/2 inches apart center to center. Using a 1/4-inch rod, apply the test load in a vertical direction at the midpoint of the crayon and through the 3/16-inch deep section. Gradually apply and increase the test load until the crayon breaks, the minimum breaking strength shall be a 3 pound load.

Preservation, packaging, packing,labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Notes. Purchaser must specify composition required.

Copies of military standards may be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the procuring contracting officer.

WHEN THIS COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION IS USED FOR PROCUREMENT, THE COMMERCIAL ITEM CERTIFICATION CLAUSE DOES NOT NEED TO APPEAR IN THE SOLICITATION.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

None.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA -FSS

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